

La Piazza, Hyatt Regency Delhi—1994

They offered Italian Before it made it to 'It' cuisine

Before Delhi had Italian restaurants in almost every neighbourhood, there was La Piazza. Today, burrata, risotto, tiramisu, regional Italian wines and wood-fired pizza barely register as exotic. But there was a time when authentic Italian dining was a discovery. La Piazza helped make that discovery possible.

But the more interesting story is not what La Piazza served. It is what it taught Delhi to appreciate. Before Italian cuisine became fashionable, diners had to learn that Italian food was not simply pasta in tomato sauce. There were regions, ingredients, wines, techniques and traditions.

La Piazza helped word that language, which makes its legacy larger than its menu. It helped create the market it would eventually become part of.

Signature Wood-fired pizza, pasta, risotto and tiramisu

The La Piazza lesson Some restaurants don't follow food trends. They introduce them.

Meal for Two ₹6,000 plus taxes



Bukhara, ITC Maurya, New Delhi—1978

The Table Where the World Came to Explore Indian Flavours

There are restaurants where celebrities dine. And then there are restaurants where history seems to have booked a table. Since opening in 1978, Bukhara has accumulated an extraordinary roll call of presidents, prime ministers, global personalities and visiting dignitaries: Bill Clinton, George W. Bush, Barack Obama and Tony Blair.

But the remarkable thing about these powerful guests is not simply that they came; it is what they came to eat—not foie gras, or a tasting menu, but for dal, kebabs, naan and meat cooked over fire. That is Bukhara's great paradox: One of India's most celebrated luxury restaurants built its mythology around food that looks almost deliberately uncomplicated. The open tandoor. The rustic interiors; communal tables, and the famously restrained menu. In a world of increasingly elaborate fine dining, Bukhara's proposition has always been almost radical in its simplicity: come hungry, eat with your hands, share your food, and let the fire do the talking.

And then there is the Bill Clinton story. During the former US President's visit, chef J.P. Singh recalls Clinton